

DVD Drive

The Xbox 360 uses a standard DVD-ROM for all its operations and all the games used on the device come on standard DVDs.

In the initial war of the next-gen disk formats, Microsoft had sided with the Toshiba-led HD-DVD camp and so released an HD-DVD add-on for the Xbox 360. However, the company later retracted this device and there have been rumours of Microsoft favouring Blu-ray for the next big console pack, sometime in 2010.



Before being beaten by Blu-ray, the Xbox 360 came with an external HD-DVD add-on drive

Hard Disk

The 'Core' version of Xbox 360, now called the 'Arcade', comes without a hard disk at all! This iteration is largely aimed at those who just want to play games and not use the 360 as a multimedia device.

The 'Arcade' model formerly came with a 256 MB Memory Unit, but now has 512 MB of built-in flash memory.

Higher-end versions of the Xbox 360 – dubbed the 'Pro' and the 'Elite' – come with 20, 60 or 120 GB hard disks. The hard disks for the 360 are in a proprietary Microsoft format, and thus cannot be swapped for higher capacity storage.



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Connectivity

While the Arcade version does not allow for internet connectivity of any kind, the Pro and Elite Xbox 360s do come with Ethernet ports so that you can play online with your friends.

A composite cable comes bundled with any of the versions, while a Pro will get you a component cable too, and an Elite will throw in HDMI. Still, all three versions do support composite, component and HDMI connectivity.